

Internet and Email Acceptable Use Policy

Sanitized public release

Document status	Public release template
Applies to	Personnel and authorized users of [Organization] information resources
Owner / approval	[Appropriate organizational authority]

Publication note: This edition preserves the policy intent while replacing organizational names with neutral placeholders and omitting internal identifiers, approval dates, revision history, contact paths, control timings, product names, and implementation-specific details.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes acceptable-use and security requirements for internet access, email, messaging, and related electronic communication services provided or authorized by [Organization].

2. Scope and applicability

This policy applies to all users of organizational internet and electronic communication services, including use from organization-managed devices and accounts.

3. Internet use

- Internet access is provided primarily for authorized business purposes. Limited incidental personal use may be permitted if it is lawful, reasonable, secure, and does not interfere with work or operations.
- Organizational internet services and accounts must not be used for unauthorized personal financial gain, commercial activity, or misrepresentation.
- Users must use organizational email addresses for subscriptions, mailing lists, and online accounts only when there is a legitimate business need.
- Users must not disable or bypass endpoint protection, filtering, scanning, content controls, or other security measures.
- Security warnings or failures must be reported promptly through approved support channels.
- Users must not access, transmit, or store unlawful, threatening, discriminatory, harassing, malicious, or otherwise prohibited content, or copyrighted content without authorization.

4. Email and electronic communications

- Use caution with links, attachments, QR codes, unexpected requests, and messages from unknown or unverified sources.
- Do not bypass malware scanning, data-loss prevention, encryption, content filtering, or other protective controls.
- Sensitive or confidential information may be sent only to authorized recipients using approved protection methods.

- Do not send spam, chain messages, deceptive messages, forged headers, impersonated communications, or excessive messages intended to disrupt service.
- Do not use organizational communications to harass, threaten, discriminate against, or unlawfully target another person.
- Before sending information externally, verify the recipient, business need, classification, attachments, and any required approval.

5. Monitoring, records, and privacy

Use of organizational internet and communication services may be logged, monitored, retained, reviewed, or disclosed as permitted by law and policy. Users should not expect personal privacy in organizational accounts or systems beyond protections required by law or formally adopted policy.

6. Reporting

Suspicious messages, potential phishing, malware warnings, misdirected communications, unauthorized disclosure, and other suspected incidents must be reported promptly through the organization's approved reporting process.

7. Enforcement and exceptions

Violations may result in restrictions, revocation of access, corrective or disciplinary action, contractual remedies, and referral to appropriate authorities. Exceptions must be written, risk-reviewed, approved by designated authorities, limited in scope and duration, and periodically reviewed.

8. Definitions

Electronic communications: Email, messaging, collaboration, conferencing, and similar services used to exchange information.

Sensitive information: Information that requires protection because unauthorized disclosure, alteration, loss, or misuse could cause harm.

Phishing: A deceptive communication intended to induce a recipient to disclose information, transfer value, or execute malicious content.